

Activity 5 - Align Stakeholders with a Map, RACI and Engagement Plan

Course: Effective Project Management for Small Projects (TGS-2020505545) Topic: 5 | Collaborate with Stakeholders Learning outcome: LO5 Duration: 75 minutes Team size: 3-4 learners Tool set: Stakeholder Map, Saliency, RACI and Engagement Assessment

Objective

Collaborate with internal and external stakeholders directly impacting the project (A5, K5).

The situation

Two weeks before outlet testing, the POS vendor and operations manager each believe the other owns interface acceptance. Store managers receive conflicting instructions, Finance has not approved the payment milestone, and a high-influence outlet supervisor is quietly resisting the pilot.

What you will do

Identify and analyse stakeholders, prioritise engagement, remove duplicate or missing accountability, and define a two-way communication rhythm tied to upcoming decisions.

What you will produce

A stakeholder register and power-interest map, saliency reading, validated RACI matrix, current-to-desired engagement assessment, communication plan and one evidence-based escalation brief.

Tool files in this folder

- [`tools/42 Stakeholder Impact Over Influence Matrix.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/43 Saliency Chart.pptx`](#)
- [`tools/39 RACI Template.xlsx`](#)
- [`tools/41 Stakeholder Engagement Assessment Matrix.xlsx`](#)

Step-by-step instructions

1. List at least 12 internal and external stakeholders: sponsor, PM, store managers, outlet staff, customers, Finance, IT, POS vendor, payment vendor, trainer and support team.
2. Open the impact-over-influence template and position every stakeholder. Write the evidence for each high-influence rating.
3. Use the saliency template to test power, legitimacy and urgency. Compare the result with the power-interest map and explain one difference.
4. Open the RACI browser tool or 39 RACI Template.xlsx. Use rows for deliverables and decisions, not job titles or vague activities.
5. Assign R, A, C and I. Enforce one accountable owner per row; flag rows with no R, no A, too many Cs or duplicated As.

6. Resolve interface acceptance, payment release, training sign-off, launch approval and change control. Record why each A sits where it does.
7. Open the engagement assessment matrix and rate current versus desired engagement for the top eight stakeholders.
8. For each material gap, define message, channel, frequency, owner, feedback mechanism and the next decision the engagement supports.
9. Draft a one-minute escalation brief for the interface ownership conflict: decision required, options, impact of delay, recommendation and deadline.
10. Role-play the meeting with another team acting as sponsor and vendor. Update the RACI and stakeholder plan from the feedback.

Evidence to submit

Complete [WORKSHEET.md](#) and attach/export the completed tool files named above.

Acceptance criteria

All material stakeholders are analysed; every critical deliverable has exactly one Accountable owner and at least one Responsible party; engagement gaps have two-way actions; and the escalation asks for a clear decision.

Debrief

- Most collaboration failures are decision-right failures before they become communication failures.
- RACI clarifies accountability; it does not replace the conversation needed to gain commitment.
- Stakeholder attention should follow evidence of influence, impact and urgency-not organisational seniority alone.

The full procedure is also reproduced in the Learner Guide, Activity 5. The trainer deck contains only the briefing and success criteria.